MC 451 Sampling Plan and Pilot rubric

75 points. Due Friday, November 6, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 75. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Length: 700 to 1,200 words across the plan and the pilot write-up, plus 10 to 20 coded items in the spreadsheet. Word counts cover your own writing, not the title, headings, tables, references, figure captions, code, or output, and writing more than the range never costs points. Scores on work that shows effort are adjusted with the course's curve: your final percentage is 25 percent plus 75 percent of your rubric percentage, so 50 of 100 on the rubric becomes 62.5. Work at two-thirds or more of the minimum length counts as showing effort. Submissions are unlimited before the deadline, so you can revise and submit again.

- The plan rows total 35 and the pilot data rows 15; the stability check is graded inside pilot data.
- Data Wrangling in R follows one week later, on Friday, November 13, so draft the plan during Week 10.

Sampling Plan and Pilot, 75 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Plan: population 6 points	**6 points.** Defines everything your claim will cover, with its edges stated (which platform, which accounts or outlets, which period).	**5 points.** Defined, but one edge is left open, so a reader could not say whether a given item belongs.	**3 to 4 points.** Named in a phrase ("YouTube comments") with no edges.	**0 to 2 points.** Missing.
Plan: sampling frame 7 points	**7 points.** Names the actual list or source you draw from, and says how it differs from the population (it always does).	**5 to 6 points.** Names the frame, but the difference from the population is stated in a phrase without saying where they differ.	**4 points.** Names the frame but treats it as the same thing as the population.	**0 to 3 points.** Missing.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Plan: method 7 points	**7 points.** Names the method (census, simple random, stratified, systematic or purposive) and gives the reason it fits your question.	**5 to 6 points.** Named, with a reason that would fit any study ("it is the most common").	**4 points.** Described without a name, or named with no reason.	**0 to 3 points.** Missing.
Plan: size, with the arithmetic 10 points	**10 points.** Gives the number of items and the arithmetic behind it: your minutes per item times the number of items, inside the two-to-four-hour budget, and the row of the sizing table you used.	**8 to 9 points.** Arithmetic shown, but the time per item is copied from the table instead of timed on your own material, or the total falls outside the budget or under fifty coded units with no word on it.	**5 to 7 points.** A number with no arithmetic ("about 200 posts"). That is a wish, not a plan: show the minutes.	**0 to 4 points.** No size.
Plan: date range and filters 5 points	**5 points.** Stated as rules someone else could apply and get the same items: dates, keywords, languages, and what is left out.	**4 points.** Stated, but one filter depends on your judgment ("relevant posts").	**3 points.** A date range only, with no word on what is left out.	**0 to 2 points.** Missing.
Pilot data: items coded 7 points	**7 points.** Ten to twenty items coded with your own codebook, submitted as a spreadsheet or CSV with one row per item.	**5 to 6 points.** Coded and submitted, but fewer than ten items, or the file is missing a variable.	**4 points.** Coding described in the document, but no data file.	**0 to 3 points.** No pilot coding.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Pilot data: stability check 8 points	**8 points.** At least a quarter of the pilot items re-coded at least 48 hours later with your first codes hidden; reports how often the two passes agreed and what you changed in the codebook as a result.	**6 to 7 points.** Re-coded and reported, but the gap, the hidden first codes, or the change it led to is not stated.	**4 to 5 points.** Re-coded too soon or with the first codes in view, or an agreement figure with no word on how it was produced.	**0 to 3 points.** No re-code.
Edge cases 10 points	**10 points.** Every edge case you hit, each with the decision you made and the rule it became.	**8 to 9 points.** Listed with decisions, but some decisions did not become written rules.	**5 to 7 points.** Listed without the decisions made, or only one case listed.	**0 to 4 points.** None listed.
Revisions the pilot forced 15 points	**15 points.** Each change the pilot forced, shown with the before and after wording.	**11 to 14 points.** Changes described, but without the before and after wording.	**8 to 10 points.** Reports that nothing changed. A pilot that changed nothing usually means it was too easy: look again at the cases that slowed you down.	**0 to 7 points.** Missing.

How big should your corpus be

Size your corpus by coding time, not by item count, because a chat message and a news article are not the same amount of work. Budget two to four hours of coding in total: roughly the first third building and revising the codebook on a small subset, and the remaining two thirds applying the frozen codebook to the full corpus.

The baseline is 250 chat messages at 45 seconds each, which is three and an eighth hours. Every other row is scaled from that one, holding the time constant and changing only the seconds one unit costs.

Corpus size by unit of analysis

Unit of analysis	Typical length	Seconds each	Corpus target
Chat or stream messages, short comments	under 20 words	45	250

Unit of analysis	Typical length	Seconds each	Corpus target
Short posts, captions, headlines	20 to 60 words	75	150
Survey open ends, product or media reviews	50 to 150 words	110	100
Long comments, forum posts, letters	150 to 400 words	220	50
News articles, blog posts, press releases	400 to 1,200 words	450	25
Video or audio coded in one-minute slices	one minute	180	60 minutes of material
Images, thumbnails, advertisements	not applicable	90	125

Calibrate against your own rate, not the table: code twenty items, time it, divide, and use that number.

Fifty coded units is the floor. If your rate puts you under fifty, do not shrink the corpus further; change the unit of analysis instead and code paragraphs or sentences inside documents.

More variables cost more time. These rates assume three to six coded variables per unit; ten variables roughly halves the rate, so either halve the corpus or cut variables, and say in the plan which you chose.

The table is a planning estimate, not your final number. Your exact sample size gets set with me once your topic and questions are in, and it is confirmed at the prospectus. Until then, plan from the table and say in the document which row you used.

Before you submit

Sampling Check turns your own coding rate and available hours into the corpus size they support, sizes the reliability subset from your rarest category, and reports the smallest effect a sample that size could detect. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.

Agreement Check takes your two coding passes as two columns and returns percent agreement, the statistic with its threshold, and the items the two passes disagree on. Set it to one coder, two passes. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.